

“gunzip filename.gz”

The file *filename.gz* will be deleted, and the extracted file, that is, *“filename”*, is created in the current folder.

Similarly, to use the zip format so that the file can be opened even on a Windows machine, you can use the zip utility:

zip filename.zip filename (to compress)

unzip filename.zip (to extract)

2.9.1 Archiving at the command prompt

You will need to know the four basic options of the tar command generally used.

C: create a new archive

V: verbose; show the files being archived

X: extract files from an archive

F: when used with *C*, it means “use the filename specified for creation for the file,” or when used with *X*, it means “use the filename specified for the extracted file.”

You can add several files to the archive with the tar utility as follows:

```
tar -cvf filename.tar /dir1/dir2/dir3 /dir1/dir2/dir3
```

The files in *dir1*, *dir2* (which is a subdirectory under *dir1*) and *dir3* (which is a subdirectory under *dir2*) will be added to the tar archive such that the directory structure is maintained in the form of *dir1*, *dir2* (created under *dir1*) and *dir3* (created under *dir2*) in the archive. You can of course, specify different folder names in the second set of directories.

Most distributions give you a GUI interface to do this. Having explained the harder way to do this, we leave you to figure out how it is done with the GUI. Have fun!